

Mid-Year Report

Six-Month Review, Full-Year Outlook
& the Acreage Question

Prepared for the Fall Planting Meeting with Chef Philip Tessier

\$48.7K

REVENUE, LAST SIX
MONTHS
(DEC '25 – MAY '26)

91

DELIVERIES
IN THE HALF-YEAR

~\$200K

REVENUE PER
ACRE,
ANNUALIZED (HALF-
ACRE)

Carrots

#1 CROP — 28% OF
HALF-YEAR
REVENUE

The Half-Year at a Glance

Press Farm is a half-acre specialty garden in Yountville supplying Chef Philip Tessier's kitchens. This report covers the **last six months (December 2025 – May 2026)**, sets them against the farm's full history, looks ahead to the rest of 2026 and the years beyond, and answers the question on the table for the fall planting meeting: **the farm has outgrown its half-acre, and the next step is more land.**

- 1 The half-year delivered \$48.7K across 91 deliveries** — a healthy winter-and-spring run, carried by a standout January (\$19.8K) on the back of a big carrot harvest. The farm enters its strong season (August–November) with momentum and a waiting list of demand it cannot yet fill.
- 2 Every square foot is already proven gold.** A half-acre is producing a trailing-twelve-month run rate near \$124K — roughly **\$200K+ per acre**, several times typical specialty-crop benchmarks. The model is validated; the obvious move is to run it across more ground.
- 3 The farm is now supply-constrained, not demand-constrained.** The best crops sell out, the August–September peak leaves orders unfilled, and winter carrots clear everything that's picked. With the second hire lifting the labor ceiling, **land is the one lever left to pull.**

THE BOTTOM LINE FOR THE PLANTING MEETING

Press Farm has done everything a half-acre can do. The economics are proven at **~\$200K+ per acre**, the kitchen wants more than the farm can grow at peak, and storable winter crops like carrots sell out every January. The growth lever is no longer intensity — it's **acreage**. Secure additional ground now (the neighboring wineries make this realistic and cheap to lease), staff it with the incoming hire, and plant it to the crops already proven to sell. **More land is the highest-return investment in front of the farm.**

01 The Last Six Months in Review

EXHIBIT 1

Monthly revenue, December 2025 – May 2026

Month	Deliveries	Revenue
December 2025	12	\$6,412
January 2026	17	\$19,831
February 2026	10	\$5,911
March 2026	10	\$3,685
April 2026	17	\$5,504
May 2026	25	\$7,350
Six-month total	91	\$48,691

January is the story of the half-year. A large winter carrot harvest drove a \$19.8K month — Carrots alone were \$12.3K of it (3,500+ units). This is not a data quirk; it is a real, repeatable winter cash crop, and it is the single most important planting signal in this report. May's 25 deliveries also show the spring cadence picking back up heading into summer.

1.1 What the kitchen pulled

EXHIBIT 2

Revenue by category, last six months

Category	Revenue	Share
Fruit & vegetables	\$20,160	41%
Herbs & leaves	\$13,364	27%
Flowers	\$13,030	27%
Microgreens	\$1,701	4%
Kits	\$436	1%
Total	\$48,691	100%

EXHIBIT 3

Top crops, last six months — these are your proven winter/spring sellers

Crop	Revenue	Share of half-year
Carrots	\$13,636	28%
Radish	\$5,325	11%
Nasturtium (leaf)	\$4,838	10%
Mustard Flowers	\$3,442	7%
Turnip	\$1,800	4%
Fava	\$1,464	3%
Kale	\$1,400	3%
Nasturtium Flowers · Cauliflower · Lettuce · Alyssum · Citrus · Bay · Yuzu · Fava Leaf	\$5,000+	combined

The top three crops — Carrots, Radish, Nasturtium — were nearly half of the half-year's revenue. This is the menu the kitchen actually reached for through winter and spring, and it is the clearest possible guide to what should go in the ground this fall.

1.2 What it cost

Cash inputs for the six months were **\$10,243** — but \$5,074 of that was equipment (one-time buildout), leaving roughly **\$3,600 in recurring biological inputs** (seed, soil, plants, amendments) against \$48.7K of revenue. In-season margin on what the farm grows remains above 90%. The economics are not the problem; capacity is.

A NOTE ON LABOR IN THE NUMBERS

Labor and grower pay are not yet captured in the system, so these figures are contribution, not fully-loaded net. The fix is cheap — log hours for one month — and it matters before any decision to hire or expand, because labor is precisely the lever this report turns on.

02 Two Houses, One Garden

Press Farm has supplied **both Press and Under-Study since Under-Study opened**. Because deliveries to the two houses have always been booked together under one account, the system cannot yet split how much produce flows to each kitchen — it has been kept, correctly, as one combined relationship.

CORRECTING AN EARLIER READ

An earlier draft of this analysis treated the farm as a "single-account" operation with concentration risk. That was a bookkeeping artifact, not reality. The farm has served two restaurants all along — the revenue simply wasn't tagged by house. The relationship is a **two-venue partnership**, and it is a strength, not a fragility.

The one practical gap this creates is planning: without a per-house split, the farm can't yet see whether Press and Under-Study want different things, or how fast each is growing. That matters directly for fall planting — if the two kitchens pull different crops or volumes, the garden should be planted to serve both menus deliberately.

RECOMMENDATION

Start tagging deliveries by house this fall

Going forward, mark each delivery as Press or Under-Study (the system already supports both as separate restaurants). Within one season this produces a clean per-house demand picture — what each kitchen orders, when, and how much — so the crop plan can be built around two menus instead of an estimate. No back-fixing of history is needed; the split simply starts now.

03 The Longer Arc — Where the Farm Has Been

The half-year sits inside a clear multi-year climb. The farm has grown from a part-year operation into a six-figure run rate in two years.

EXHIBIT 4

Revenue by year

Year	Revenue	Deliveries	Note
2024 (Jul–Dec)	\$34,182	115	First half-year of records
2025 (full year)	\$102,501	209	First six-figure year
2026 (Jan–Jun, partial)	\$44,122	87	Tracking ahead of 2025 pace
Trailing 12 months	~\$124,000	—	Current run rate

Two things stand out. First, **revenue per delivery has risen ~65%** since 2024 — the farm is earning more per drop through premium specialty crops, not by running the truck more often. Second, the year has a strong, dependable shape.

EXHIBIT 5

The shape of the year — average monthly revenue, two-year basis



Dark = peak, light = trough. Two revenue mountains: a summer/early-fall peak (Aug–Sep, ~\$45K of the year across Aug–Nov) and a winter carrot peak (January). The soft spots are February–March and December.

The strategic read is simple: **the farm already knows when its money comes in.** The opportunity is to defend the two peaks (don't run short at the August–September top) and to keep feeding the January carrot peak — which is exactly what fall planting decides.

04 The Rest of 2026

The farm has banked \$44.1K through mid-June and is walking into its biggest months. Three scenarios for the full year, anchored on last year's strong second half (\$75.5K) and current momentum:

EXHIBIT 6

Full-year 2026 scenarios

Scenario	Assumption for Jul-Dec	Full-year 2026	vs 2025
Conservative	Peak underperforms / weather softens	~\$106K	+4%
Most likely	Second half near 2025 with modest growth	~\$122K	+19%
Strong	Peak fully supplied, momentum carries	~\$144K	+41%

The difference between "most likely" and "strong" is almost entirely **whether the August–September peak can be supplied to full demand**. That is a capacity question, not a sales question — the orders are there in peak season; the limit is growing space, hands, and harvest-ready crops. **The half-acre tops out before the orders do, which is precisely why more ground is the next move.**

WHAT TO PLANT THIS FALL — STRAIGHT FROM THE DATA

The crops that carried the last six months *are* the fall planting list: **carrots** (the January engine — plant generously and in succession), **radish & turnip** (fast winter cash), **brassicas** — cauliflower, broccoli, kale, **favas** (corn-field rotation), winter **lettuce**, and the cool-season flowers the kitchen pulls year-round — **nasturtium, mustard flower, alyssum**. Citrus and yuzu from the orchard round out winter. Plant what already sells before planting anything speculative.

05 The Case for More Land

Should Press Farm grow beyond its half-acre? The data gives a clear answer: **yes — acquiring more land is the single highest-return move the farm can make.** The model is proven, demand outruns supply, and the labor ceiling is lifting. The only thing missing is ground.

5.1 The farm today is fully built out

The half-acre is laid out in defined blocks — the corn field (8 rows, corn and fava), the tomato field (22 rows), the field beside the corn (14 rows), the orchard (17 rows), the passionfruit field (15 rows), plus permanent flower rows along the back and sides. Roughly 75+ production rows at 25' × 30", worked at full intensity. **There is no slack left to plant into** — every block is in rotation, which is exactly why the next unit of growth has to come from new ground.

THE NUMBER THAT MAKES THE CASE

A half-acre is producing a **~\$124K trailing-twelve-month run rate — about \$200,000+ per acre.** Typical California specialty-vegetable ground grosses a fraction of that; even intensive market gardens reach only \$50–100K per acre. Press Farm runs at **two to four times** that because it grows high-value specialty crops for a fine-dining kitchen. **When each acre is worth \$200K+, the most valuable thing the farm can buy is another acre.**

5.2 Four reasons the farm is ready to expand

EXHIBIT 7

The case for adding ground

Signal	What the data shows	Read
Proven economics	~\$200K+ per acre — every new acre run the same way is a six-figure asset	Expand
Supply-constrained peak	Aug–Sep orders exceed what a half-acre can grow; the "strong" scenario gap is unfilled demand, not soft sales	Expand
Sold-out winter crops	Carrots and roots clear everything picked each January — storable, repeatable, capacity-limited	Expand
Land is available & cheap	Neighboring wineries can lease ground — low capital outlay, no purchase required	Expand

The pattern is consistent: **the farm sells more than it can grow, and the bottleneck has always been square footage.** A proven \$200K/acre system with a waiting list of demand and access to cheap adjacent land is the textbook case for scaling up.

5.3 What new ground is worth

Adding a half-acre on the same model — phased in block by block as the crew grows — roughly **doubles the farm's production capacity**. Run at even a conservative fraction of current intensity, the upside is substantial:

EXHIBIT 8

Adding a half-acre — illustrative economics

Line	Estimate
Added revenue / year (half-acre at 70–100% of current per-acre intensity)	\$70,000 – \$100,000
Recurring inputs (seed, soil, amendments — ~7% of revenue)	(\$5,000 – \$7,000)
Land lease (winery-adjacent ground, est.)	(\$1,000 – \$4,000)
Added labor (second hire + seasonal help)	(to be logged)
Gross contribution before labor / year	\$60,000 – \$90,000

Illustrative and phased — not all at once. Even at half this pace, a leased half-acre clears its land and input costs in a single season and adds a five-figure contribution. The math scales with the proven per-acre figure; the only question is how fast the crew can grow into it.

5.4 Labor scales with the land

One real input has to grow alongside the ground: **hands**. The good news is that the labor expansion is already underway — a second hire is in process, and the work argues for completing it. Each new block of proven, high-margin crops more than pays for the labor to tend it, so labor is not a barrier to expansion but a **companion investment** that the new revenue funds. Pair every new block of land with the crew to work it, and the farm grows in balance.

THE VERDICT

Acquire more land — start now. Lease winery-adjacent ground, phase it in block by block as the second hire (and seasonal help) come online, and plant it to the crops already proven to sell: winter carrots and roots, the supply-short peak-season flowers and herbs, and selective perennials. At ~\$200K+ per acre with demand outrunning supply, every acre the farm can staff is a six-figure opportunity. The half-acre proved the model — **more land is how it scales**.

06 The Years to Come

Growth from here is led by **land** — expand the ground, staff it, and run the proven model across more acres. These targets tie directly to acreage and the crew that works it. Hit the inputs and the revenue follows the per-acre figure the farm has already established.

EXHIBIT 9

The expansion path, 2026–2028

Driver	2026 (base)	2027 (target)	2028 (target)
Growing area	0.5 acre	0.75 acre	1.0 acre
Crew	Grower + Fri. helper	Grower + 1 full hire	Grower + 1 + seasonal
Houses served (tracked)	2, blended	2, split by house	2 + events / new account
Revenue	~\$122K	~\$165K	~\$220K
Winter-month floor	~\$5K	~\$9K	~\$13K

Anchored to the proven ~\$200K/acre rate, scaled conservatively as crew and ground come online together. Doubling to a full acre by 2028 roughly doubles capacity — and because winter root crops store and sell out, the added ground also lifts the farm's softest months, smoothing cash flow into a steadier year-round operation for both kitchens.

07 Recommendations

EXHIBIT 10

What to do, in order

#	Action	Horizon
1	Secure additional land now — open talks with neighboring wineries to lease ~0.25–0.5 acre of workable ground. This is the growth lever; everything else supports it.	This meeting
2	Complete the second hire — staff the new ground; each block of proven crops funds the labor to work it.	Now
3	Plant the new ground to proven sellers — lead with carrots in succession (the January engine), roots, brassicas, and the supply-short peak flowers and herbs. Scale what already sells.	Fall–Winter
4	Defend & deepen the Aug–Sep peak — the new acreage exists to fill the orders the half-acre couldn't. Plan crew and succession plantings so nothing goes unpicked.	Summer
5	Tag deliveries by house (Press vs Under-Study) starting now, to build a per-kitchen demand picture that guides where the new ground goes.	This fall

6	Log labor hours for one month so the expansion's true net — and the payback on each new block — is measured, not estimated.	Immediate
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Methodology & notes. Revenue = realized deliveries and delivery line items (the financial source of truth), not order intent. Figures exclude grower pay and labor, which are not yet captured in the system, so totals are contribution rather than fully-loaded net. Half-year window: December 2025 – May 2026 (six complete months); full history begins July 2024. Press and Under-Study deliveries have historically been booked as one combined account and cannot yet be split by house. Per-acre figures annualize the trailing-twelve-month run rate over the stated half-acre. Forecasts and the expansion economics are scenario estimates for planning, built on observed sell-through, the established per-acre rate, and seasonality — directional, not guarantees; actuals depend on weather, labor, lease terms, and kitchen demand. · Press Farm OS, Yountville, CA.